CHAPTER THREE

INTELLIGENCE AND NATIONAL SECURITY

Military Doctrine in the Absence of Strategic Depth

This chapter was conceived at the beginning of 2016, when a delegation of Chinese (apparently retired) generals came to visit IDC (Interdisciplinary Center) Herzliya and asked to hear a lecture on the subject of intelligence and national security. I thought that a good joke at the beginning of my lecture would help to break the ice, and so I asked our guests if China was suffering from a lack of strategic depth. I did not succeed in getting them to crack a smile.

Israel's *military* doctrine, in contrast to its national security doctrine, began to crystallize after the War of Independence. With the signing of the armistice agreements, the nascent State of Israel covered an area of twenty thousand square kilometers. Its Jewish population numbered about 750,000 (approximately 600,000 of whom were already there before the establishment of the state and another 150,000 of whom had arrived during the war) and a minority population of about 120,000. The tiny country was surrounded by Lebanon, Syria, Jordan, and Egypt, relations with which were based on a regime of armistice agreements. Iraq, which had taken part in the war, had refrained from signing an armistice agreement, so under international law Israel and Iraq are in a de facto state of war to this day.

During the first twenty-five years of independence we experienced five wars: the War of Independence from 1947 to 1949; the Sinai Campaign of